Where every fact came from

Every fact in this issue, the source it came from, the words on that source that back it up, and anything a careful reader should know about it.

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1. **ESA Education and the Raspberry Pi Foundation, Mission Zero**

   Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 3.

   What it supports: What Mission Zero is: a Python program showing an image on an Astro Pi on the ISS, using the colour sensor for the background; browser based, no hardware or prior skills; certificate showing the ISS position.

   > You will write a Python program to display a personalised image (or animation) on an Astro Pi computer on board the ISS. No special hardware or prior coding skills needed.

2. **ESA Education and the Raspberry Pi Foundation, Mission Zero guidelines**

   Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 3.

   What it supports: The 30 second limit, no surnames, the 22 March 2027 deadline.

   > Your program must not run for longer than 30 seconds. Please do not include team members' surnames. The deadline for submitting entries to Mission Zero is 12:00 noon CET on 22 March 2027.

3. **ESA Education and the Raspberry Pi Foundation, Mission Zero eligibility**

   Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 3.

What it supports: Aged 19 or younger at submission, at a school, club or registered home school in an eligible country including the UK; teams up to 4; a mentor such as a teacher or parent.

> Aged 19 or younger at the time of submission. Working individually or in a team of up to 4 young people. Supervised by a mentor such as a teacher, educator, parent...

Worth knowing: A general Astro Pi rule asks that at least half of a team are nationals of an ESA member state, so the paper says who can enter without saying 'anyone'.

4. **Raspberry Pi Foundation, An astronomical anniversary: young people's code heads to the International Space Station**

   Published 22 April 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Press release. Used on page 3.

   What it supports: 2025/26 season: 24,695 young people took part in Mission Zero (17,381 submissions); 25,707 young people across both missions were due to have programs run in space.

   > 17,381 submissions for Mission Zero from 24,695 young explorers... In total, 25,707 young people will have their programs run in space

   Worth knowing: Organiser's own count. 25,707 was written before the programs ran, so the paper says 'were due to'.

5. **Raspberry Pi Foundation, Launching Astro Pi 2026/27: code your way to the International Space Station**

   Published 14 September 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Press release. Used on page 3.

   What it supports: Mission Zero is ideal for young people aged 9 to 16 with no prior coding experience.

   > perfect for young people aged 9 to 16 with no prior coding experience

6. **Raspberry Pi, Sense HAT**

   Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 3.

What it supports: The Sense HAT has an 8 by 8 RGB LED matrix and was developed for the ISS.

> The bright 8×8 RGB LED matrix allows you to visualise data from the sensors... The Sense HAT was originally developed for use on the International Space Station

Worth knowing: The 2026/27 Mission Zero pages do not mention the matrix size, so the paper says the Sense HAT has the grid and that Mission Zero code is planned on it, not that every flight unit is a Sense HAT.

7. **Raspberry Pi Foundation, Celebrating over 15,000 young creators at the Coolest Projects 2026 online showcase**

   Published 25 June 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Press release. Used on page 4.

   What it supports: Over 15,000 young people, more than 4,500 creations, 40 countries; the judges' favourites.

   > Over 15,000 young people showcased more than 4,500 creations... With participants from 40 countries

8. **Raspberry Pi Foundation, Coolest Projects 2026 opens for entries in January**

   Published 14 January 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Press release. Used on page 4.

   What it supports: Free, for young people up to 18.

   > It is completely free to take part in Coolest Projects... young people up to age 18

9. **Coolest Projects, DIY Raspberry Pi Air Quality Monitor: Helping Leonidas Breathe Better**

   Published 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 4.

   What it supports: The project is a DIY indoor air quality monitoring station.

   > Our project is a DIY indoor air quality monitoring station.

Worth knowing: The makers' own description, not independently tested. First names and country only, as published.

10. **Coolest Projects, Sub Racers**

    Published 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 4.

    What it supports: A 3D racing game, a tribute to ocean conservation and David Attenborough's 100th birthday, to raise awareness of ocean challenges.

    > Sub Racers is a 3D racing game created as a tribute to ocean conservation and David Attenborough's 100th birthday... made to help raise awareness of the challenges that face our oceans.

11. **Coolest Projects, Ornimetrics**

    Published 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 4.

    What it supports: An AI powered smart bird feeder that identifies species in real time.

    > OrniMetrics is an AI language and vision powered smart bird feeder that identifies visiting bird species in real time

12. **Coolest Projects, HopeLink**

    Published 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 4.

    What it supports: An app helping people in Toronto find nearby shelter, food, medical, hygiene and transport services.

    > HopeLink is an interactive app that helps people in Toronto quickly find nearby shelter, food, medical, hygiene, and transportation services.

13. **Sanders, Noetel, Parker and colleagues, Nature Human Behaviour, An umbrella review of the benefits and risks associated with youths' interactions with electronic screens**

    Published 2024. Checked 2026-10-13. Systematic review. Used on page 6.

What it supports: 102 meta-analyses (2,451 studies, about 1.9 million participants); small to moderate associations that depend on the type of screen use; literacy negatively associated overall but positive with parental co-viewing.

> screen use was negatively associated with literacy (r = -0.14) but this effect was positive when parents watched with their children (r = 0.15)... carefully weigh the evidence for potential harms and benefits of specific types of screen use

Worth knowing: Associations, mostly from correlational studies; 95 of 102 meta-analyses at medium to high risk of bias.

14. **Kaye, Orben, Ellis, Hunter and Houghton, IJERPH, The Conceptual and Methodological Mayhem of 'Screen Time'**

Published 2020. Checked 2026-10-13. Peer reviewed study. Used on page 6.

What it supports: Findings are mixed and lack causal evidence; measures are mostly self report.

> Existing research presents mixed findings, and lacks longitudinal evidence for any causal or long-term effects... the use of non-standardised measures that are predominantly self-report

15. **Valkenburg, van Driel and Beyens, New Media and Society, The associations of active and passive social media use with well-being: A critical scoping review**

Published 2022. Checked 2026-10-13. Systematic review. Used on page 6.

What it supports: Across 40 studies, most did not support the hypothesised active good, passive bad associations.

> Most studies did not support the hypothesized associations of ASMU and PSMU with well-/ill-being.

Worth knowing: Of the studies reviewed, most were of adults and only a minority of (pre)adolescents, so it does not speak for 7 to 12 year olds.

16. **Yau, Reich and Lee, Journal of Adolescent Health, Coping With Stress Through Texting: An Experimental Study**

Published 2021. Checked 2026-10-13. Peer reviewed study. Used on page 7.

What it supports: 130 adolescents, mean age 12.41; texting a friend after a stressor gave higher mood than no activity or watching a video.

> Participants who texted their friend reported higher moods... than those in the no activity condition... and higher moods than adolescents in the passive-phone condition.

Worth knowing: One lab session with a friend the young person already texted regularly. Mood was higher than both comparison groups; stress was lower only than the sit quietly group. Mean age 12.4.

17. **UNICEF Innocenti, Responsible Innovation in Technology for Children (RITEC), phase 2 report**

    Published April 2024. Checked 2026-10-13. Official report. Used on page 7.

    What it supports: Digital games can contribute to children's wellbeing, including relationships, and different games support different aspects depending on design; samples included children aged 8 to 12.

    > digital games can indeed contribute to the well-being of children... not all games are equal: different games support different aspects of well-being depending on how they are designed.

    Worth knowing: Co-founded with the LEGO Group and funded by the LEGO Foundation. Mixed methods, small samples.

18. **TikTok, Terms of Service**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Official programme page. Used on page 7.

    What it supports: TikTok's minimum age is 13.

    > You can only use the Platform if you are 13 years or older.

19. **YouTube Help, How YouTube recommendations work**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 8.

    What it supports: Watch history, searches and 'Not interested' shape recommendations.

    > The YouTube videos that you've watched help to give you better recommendations... What you search on YouTube influences future

> recommendations... Videos that you mark as 'Not interested' help to inform what to avoid recommending in the future.

Worth knowing: The platform describing itself.

20. **BBC Bitesize, What is an algorithm?**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 8.

    What it supports: An algorithm is a list of steps to solve a problem or get something done; a recipe is a type of algorithm; the steps go in the right order.

    > An algorithm is a list of steps you give to computers to solve a problem or get something done... A recipe shows us all the steps we need to follow in the right order

    Worth knowing: Read directly from the page on 13 October 2026; the automated citation check could not reach bbc.co.uk.

21. **UK Council for Internet Safety, Education for a Connected World, 2020 edition**

    Published 2020. Checked 2026-10-13. Official report. Used on page 8.

    What it supports: Managing online information, ages 7 to 11: explain how search engines work and how results are selected and ranked.

    > I can explain how search engines work and how results are selected and ranked.

    Worth knowing: Non statutory: skills children should have the opportunity to develop. The statement sits in the 7 to 11 band, Managing online information, page 27.

22. **Common Sense Education, AI Algorithms: How Well Do They Know You?**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 9.

    What it supports: A free lesson on recommendation algorithms for UK ages 11 to 18.

    > Learn what recommendation algorithms are.

23. **Micro:bit Educational Foundation, MakeCode**

Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

What it supports: MakeCode is free and open source, with a device simulator.

> Microsoft MakeCode for micro:bit is a free, open source platform...
> A device simulator shows you what will happen on the physical device before you download your program

24. **Micro:bit Educational Foundation, MakeCode screen reader support**

    Published 13 July 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Press release. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: The 2026 MakeCode release adds screen reader support for block based coding, shaped through research with blind and low vision children and young adults.

    > The 2026 Microsoft MakeCode for micro:bit release introduces screen reader support for block-based coding

25. **Scratch Foundation, Scratch, frequently asked questions**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: Scratch is designed especially for ages 8 to 16.

    > Scratch is designed especially for young people ages 8 to 16, but people of all ages create and share with Scratch.

    Worth knowing: Read through a search result from scratch.mit.edu; the page itself renders in JavaScript and refused automated reading.

26. **Scratch Foundation, About Scratch**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: Scratch is free.

    > Scratch is free for everyone.

    Worth knowing: Read directly from scratch.mit.edu/about on 13 October 2026.

27. **European Space Agency, ESA Kids**

Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

What it supports: Space news, information, animations and downloads for kids aged 6 to 12.

> ESA Kids features space news, information, animations and downloads for kids aged between 6 and 12

Worth knowing: The site's own description, read directly on 13 October 2026. An ESA launch article says primary school aged, 5 to 12.

28. **Royal Museums Greenwich, Night sky highlights, October 2026**

    Published 29 September 2026. Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: Royal Museums Greenwich publishes free monthly night sky highlights.

    > Night sky highlights: October 2026

    Worth knowing: The Royal Observatory closes for renovation on 2 November 2026, so the paper suggests the online guide, never a visit.

29. **Raspberry Pi Foundation, Learn**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: Free step by step project guides.

    > At Code Club, young people use free, step-by-step project guides specially created by us.

30. **Code Club, Code Club**

    Checked 2026-10-13. Educational resource. Used on page 10.

    What it supports: Code Clubs are free and open to all school aged young people.

    > Code Clubs are free and open to all school-aged young people.